

Richard Saupe

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Professional Summary

Senior Software & Infrastructure Automation Engineer with a deep background in cloud architecture, advanced automation, security, and networking. Proven track record at organizations like Dropbox and FreightWise building internal developer tools, automating infrastructure provisioning, and eliminating operational toil through custom software solutions. Adept at scaling AWS cloud footprints, optimizing CI/CD workflows, and driving engineering best practices in a highly collaborative, production-critical environment.

Relevant Skills

DevOps & Infrastructure: AWS Cloud, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab

Programming / Automation: Python, Bash, JavaScript, Java, Perl, C/C++, C# .NET, REST APIs

Networking & InfoSec: SSH, SSL/TLS, Certificate Management, IAM, Encryption, Vulnerability Remediation

Observability & Reliability: CloudWatch, Sentry, New Relic, PagerDuty, Prometheus/Grafana

Testing & Code Quality: Playwright, Selenium, PyTest, JUnit, Postman, Performance Testing (JMeter, Locust)

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer | FreightWise, Brentwood, TN Mar. 2025 – Present

Lead automation engineering efforts across the product line to streamline software delivery, optimize developer velocity, and safeguard production stability.

- **CI/CD Pipeline Architecture:** Implemented automated smoke testing for GitHub Actions pipelines across multiple interconnected services; engineered custom GitHub Actions to seamlessly trigger and orchestrate tests from external repositories.
- **Advanced Automation & AI Tooling:** Supported the integration of agentic AI software engineering tools (Cursor, Devin, Claude, Kiro) into the ecosystem to significantly accelerate test suite and tool development. Designed maintainable automation frameworks using Python and Playwright that ensure reliable service deployments.
- **Process Optimization:** Drove strategic initiatives to modernize engineering quality processes.
- **Developer Enablement:** Improved front end application testability by enforcing the implementation of unique element identifiers and custom page components, making automated verification increasingly self-service for the wider engineering team.

Senior Software Engineer | Dropbox, San Francisco, CA Dec. 2022 – Dec. 2024

Designed, scaled, and maintained critical production services across infrastructure, automation, security, and edge access systems.

- **Operational Toil Reduction:** Built internal tools, scripts, and automation workflows using Shell scripting, Python, and Playwright to replace repetitive manual engineering tasks, saving significant development hours.
- **Internal Tooling & APIs:** Developed robust APIs and internal software solutions to support cross-functional system integrations and improve internal developer application capabilities.

- **Observability & Reliability:** Revolutionized system monitoring, error detection, and real-time alerting for critical engineering and customer flows using CloudWatch, Sentry, New Relic, and PagerDuty to ensure maximal up-time and system resilience.
- **Production Security Architecture:** Managed secure remote edge access and VPN configurations, ensuring production environments complied with rigorous enterprise data privacy and encryption standards.

Principal Engineer | FormSwift, San Francisco, CA

Feb. 2019 – Dec. 2022

Led architectural strategy for test automation frameworks and supporting infrastructure to maintain service stability through complex system migrations.

- **Infrastructure as Code & Containers:** Architected and deployed auto-scaling AWS ECS infrastructure integrated with Docker to enable parallel execution and minimize runtime constraints for automated environments.
- **Cloud Security Hardening:** Directly improved cloud security posture across production systems through tight implementation of AWS Secrets Manager, least-privilege IAM policies, and automated cryptographic key rotations.
- **Framework Engineering:** Designed and built scalable UI and backend automation frameworks utilizing Python and Selenium to eliminate regression risks during core infrastructure shifts.

Senior SDET | Change Healthcare, Nashville, TN

Jan. 2016 – Feb. 2019

Served as an SME and technical lead across Agile engineering teams to guarantee production reliability, architect CI/CD infrastructure, and spearhead critical microservice projects.

- **Microservice Platform Engineering:** Led a strategic engineering effort to build and deploy a custom data de-identification service, seamlessly integrating it into the core company microservice platform.
- **Infrastructure & CI/CD Pipelines:** Designed and built automated testing and deployment pipelines using GitLab CI/CD tightly integrated with Docker containerized environments.
- **Technical Leadership & Mentorship:** Acted as a key technical resource and subject matter expert (SME) for engineering managers and cross-functional peers, mentoring teams and ensuring high code quality throughout the project lifecycle.
- **Global Transition Strategy:** Utilized specialized talent processes to plan and execute a global engineering transition, successfully mitigating business impact and preserving critical product architecture knowledge.
- **Advanced Validation Frameworks:** Engineered robust automated test architectures covering functional, performance, regression, and REST API layers by driving Test-Driven Development (TDD) and Behavior-Driven Development (BDD) best practices.

Education & Certifications

BS in Telecommunications Management | DeVry University, Long Beach, CA

CTFL | ISTQB – Certified Tester

CSM | Scrum Alliance – Certified Scrum Master

Open Source

Contributed To: CircuitPython and the Arcade library

OpenSEA Alliance: open-source **NEA Protocol Implementation (RFC 5209)** for Open1X Supplicant

Community Mentorship: Champion of **CoderDojo** in the local community, serving as a mentor and community partner at regional schools to teach coding, foundational computer literacy, and engineering basics to K-12 students.